Clear - App Expansion Plan (Option B)

Date: December 19, 2025
Goal: Define complete app experience before backend integration

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Overview

We're pausing AI integration (Step 3) to map the full user experience first. This ensures we build backend infrastructure once, comprehensively, rather than rebuilding as new features emerge.

Core Principle: Design emerges through use. We'll define personas → user journeys → screens → data model, then build backend to support everything at once.

Phase 1: User Research & Definition

Session 1A: User Personas (1-2 hours)

Goal: Crystallize who we're building for and what they need

Activities:

1. **Primary Persona Deep Dive**
   - Refine "The Efficient Athlete" persona
   - Demographics, behaviors, motivations
   - Pain points and goals
   - Technology comfort level
   - Workout habits and constraints
2. **Secondary Personas (If Applicable)**
   - Identify 1-2 edge cases worth considering
   - Example: Complete beginner vs. experienced lifter
   - Example: Home gym only vs. commercial gym access
3. **Anti-Personas**
   - Who is this NOT for?
   - Helps maintain focus and avoid feature creep

Deliverables:

- `Clear_-_User_Personas.md` - Detailed persona documents
- Key quotes and scenarios for each persona

Success Criteria:

- Can answer "Would [persona] use this feature?" for any decision
- Personas feel like real people, not stereotypes
- Clear understanding of constraints (time, equipment, experience)

Session 1B: User Journey Mapping (2-3 hours)

Goal: Map complete user experience from first open to habitual use

Activities:

1. First-Time User Journey (Onboarding)

Touchpoints:

- App download/open
- Welcome screen
- Setup/configuration
- First workout generation
- First workout execution
- First save/completion

Map:

- User actions at each step
- Emotions (excited? confused? overwhelmed?)
- Pain points and friction
- Opportunities to delight
- Critical decision points

2. Returning User Journey (Typical Session)

Touchpoints:

- Open app (what do they see?)
- Navigate to workout generation
- Generate → Review → Execute
- Save session
- Return to app (what's next?)

Map:

- Frequency of use (daily? 3x/week?)
- Context (at gym? planning ahead?)
- Time constraints (how fast must this be?)
- Variability (always same flow? sometimes different?)

3. Edge Case Journeys

- **Equipment conflict:** Rack is taken, need to swap exercise
- **Injury/limitation:** Shoulder hurts today, modify workout
- **Review history:** Want to see what weight I used last time
- **Update settings:** Changed gyms, update equipment access

Deliverables:

- `Clear_-_User_Journey_Maps.md` - Complete journey documentation
- Visual journey maps (can be ASCII art or simple diagrams)
- Identified friction points and opportunities

Success Criteria:

- Every screen in the app has a clear "how did user get here?" answer
- No dead ends or confusing transitions
- Time-to-workout clearly optimized (30-second goal maintained)

- Edge cases handled gracefully

Phase 2: Screen Definition & Wireframing

Session 2A: Information Architecture (1 hour)

Goal: Define app structure and navigation

Activities:

1. **Screen Inventory**
   - List all screens (existing + new)
   - Define purpose of each screen
   - Identify primary and secondary actions
2. **Navigation Model**
   - How do users move between screens?
   - What's the hierarchy? (Home → Generation → Review → Execute)
   - What's always accessible? (Settings, History)
   - Back button behavior
3. **Content Priorities**
   - What's most important on each screen?
   - What can be hidden/collapsed?
   - What deserves prominence?

Deliverables:

- `Clear_-_Information_Architecture.md` - Screen map and navigation flow
- Sitemap/screen hierarchy diagram

Success Criteria:

- User can reach any screen in 2 taps or fewer
- Navigation is predictable and consistent
- No orphaned screens or circular logic

Session 2B: Screen Wireframes - Onboarding (1-2 hours)

Goal: Design first-time user setup flow

Screens to Design:

1. **Welcome Screen**
   - Value proposition
   - "Get Started" CTA
2. **Experience Level**
   - Beginner / Intermediate / Advanced
   - Brief explanation of what this affects
3. **Equipment Access**
   - Select available equipment
   - Option to set up multiple locations
4. **Limitations/Notes** (Optional)
   - Text input for injuries or preferences
   - Can skip if none
5. **Onboarding Complete**
   - Quick summary
   - "Generate First Workout" CTA

Design Considerations:

- Mobile-first (large touch targets)
- Progress indicator (step 1 of 4, etc.)
- Skip options for non-critical fields
- Maintain Cyberpunk aesthetic
- Fast (< 2 minutes total)

Deliverables:

- `Clear_-_Screen_4__Onboarding_Flow__Wireframe_.md` - Complete wireframe specs
- ASCII mockups like original 3 screens

Success Criteria:

- Onboarding takes < 2 minutes
- User understands why each question is asked
- Can skip optional fields without confusion
- Immediately actionable after completion

Session 2C: Screen Wireframes - Home/Dashboard (1 hour)

Goal: Design landing screen for returning users

Key Elements:

- **Generate Workout CTA** (primary action, prominent)
- **Recent Workouts** (last 3-5 sessions, quick view)
- **Streak/Consistency** (optional: "5 workouts this week")
- **Navigation** (Settings, History)

Design Considerations:

- Fast access to generation (1 tap from open)
- Glanceable history (don't need full details)
- Motivational elements subtle, not gamified
- Maintain dark Cyberpunk aesthetic

Deliverables:

- `Clear_-_Screen_5__Home_Dashboard__Wireframe_.md`

Success Criteria:

- Primary action (Generate Workout) takes < 1 second to tap
- Recent history visible without scrolling

- Not cluttered or overwhelming

Session 2D: Screen Wireframes - Workout History (1 hour)

Goal: Design past session review

Key Elements:

- **Session List** (date, anchor, intensity, duration)
- **Session Detail View** (tap to expand full workout)
- **Filter/Sort** (by date, anchor type, intensity)
- **Notes Display** (user notes from execution)

Design Considerations:

- List view (scannable)
- Tap to expand for full details
- Search/filter if history grows large
- Export option? (future consideration)

Deliverables:

- Clear_-_Screen_6__Workout_History__Wireframe_.md

Success Criteria:

- Easy to find "what did I do last week?"
- Notes from workout preserved and visible
- Can reference historical data quickly

Session 2E: Screen Wireframes - Settings/Profile (1 hour)

Goal: Design preference management

Key Elements:

- **Default Preferences** (intensity, duration)
- **Locations** (saved gyms with equipment)
- **Limitations** (injuries, preferences)
- **Account** (future: auth, sync, export)

Design Considerations:

- Organized sections (not flat list)
- Inline editing where possible
- Clear labels and help text
- Maintain minimalist aesthetic

Deliverables:

- Clear_-_Screen_7__Settings_Profile__Wireframe_.md

Success Criteria:

- Settings are findable and understandable
- Changes save immediately (no "Save" button needed)
- Doesn't feel overwhelming

Phase 3: Data Model Definition

Session 3: Data Architecture (2-3 hours)

Goal: Define what backend needs to store and serve

Activities:

1. Entity Modeling

Based on all wireframes, define:

- **User Profile** (what persists about the user?)
- **Workout Session** (what gets saved after each workout?)

- **Historical Aggregates** (what's computed for "Last: 115-135lbs"?)
- **Settings/Preferences** (what's user-configurable?)

2. Relationships

- How do entities relate?
- What's nested vs. referenced?
- What needs to be queryable?

3. API Requirements

- What endpoints will frontend need?
- What does AI generation require as input?
- What does AI need to return?
- How does historical data flow?

4. Storage Strategy

- What goes in database? (user data, sessions)
- What's computed on-demand? (stats, aggregates)
- What's cached? (recent history)

Deliverables:

- `Clear_-_Data_Model.md` - Complete schema documentation
- Entity-relationship diagrams (can be ASCII)
- API endpoint specifications (rough)

Success Criteria:

- Every screen's data needs are accounted for
- Clear understanding of what persists vs. computes
- No obvious data model gaps or redundancies

Phase 4: Lovable Implementation

Session 4A: Build Onboarding Screens (1-2 hours)

Process:

1. Take onboarding wireframes to Lovable
2. Use existing design system (locked)
3. Generate screens with mock data/logic
4. Export and integrate into clear-app

Deliverables:

- Working onboarding flow (mock data)
- Integrated into existing app

Session 4B: Build Home/Dashboard (1 hour)

Process:

1. Take Home wireframe to Lovable
2. Use existing design system
3. Mock recent workouts data
4. Export and integrate

Deliverables:

- Working Home/Dashboard screen
- Navigation integrated

Session 4C: Build History & Settings (1-2 hours)

Process:

1. Take History and Settings wireframes to Lovable

2. Use existing design system
3. Mock workout history data
4. Export and integrate

Deliverables:

- Working History screen (with mock sessions)
- Working Settings screen (with mock preferences)

Phase 5: Backend & AI Integration

Session 5: Build Complete Backend (3-5 hours)

Now we build infrastructure once, supporting everything:

1. **Database Setup** (Supabase or Firebase)
   - User profiles table
   - Workout sessions table
   - Settings/preferences
2. **Backend API** (Express or serverless)
   - User CRUD endpoints
   - Session save/retrieve
   - Historical data aggregation
3. **Claude API Integration**
   - Workout generation endpoint
   - Takes user profile + preferences as context
   - Returns structured workout data
   - Considers historical data for variety
4. **Authentication** (minimal)
   - Simple email/password or social auth
   - Just enough to associate data with user

Deliverables:

- Working backend infrastructure
- Real workout generation
- Data persistence across sessions
- Authentication flow

Timeline Estimate

Phase 1: 3-5 hours (Personas + Journey Mapping)
Phase 2: 5-8 hours (Wireframing all new screens)
Phase 3: 2-3 hours (Data model definition)
Phase 4: 3-5 hours (Lovable implementation)
Phase 5: 3-5 hours (Backend + AI integration)

Total: 16-26 hours of focused work

Realistic Pace: 2-4 weeks if working a few hours at a time

Success Criteria (Overall)

By the end of this plan, you'll have:

✅ **Complete app experience** - Onboarding → Generation → Execution → History → Settings
✅ **Real AI workout generation** - Claude API integrated
✅ **Data persistence** - User profiles, workout history, preferences saved
✅ **Proper architecture** - Backend built once, supports all features
✅ **Production-ready** - Deployed, shareable, usable by real people

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What We're NOT Building (Scope Control)

❌ Playlist recommendations
❌ Social features (sharing workouts, following friends)
❌ Progress analytics/charts (beyond basic history)
❌ Workout templates/library
❌ Video demonstrations
❌ Nutrition tracking
❌ Integrations (Apple Health, Strava, etc.)

These are future considerations, not MVP.

When to Deviate from This Plan

This plan assumes:

- Lovable can generate screens using existing design system
- Wireframes inform what's needed (no major redesigns)
- Backend work is straightforward once data model is clear

If you hit blockers:

- Collapse phases (e.g., wireframe + build same session)
- Skip phases if momentum is high
- Adjust based on what you learn

Remember the principle: Design emerges through use. This plan gets you to a complete, usable product. Iterate from there.

Next Action

Start Phase 1, Session 1A: User Personas

Ready when you are! 🚀